DFO (Vance Mercer) Incomplete or Inadequate letter (December 8, 2025) 25-HPAC-01158

	DFO Comment	Response:
1	Figure 2.2 depicts the North cofferdam; however, Section 2.1.4 states that “Four cofferdams are required, two at the north end and two at the south end of the tunnel alignment.” Please update Figure 2.2 to include the second cofferdam at the north end, as it is not currently shown.	Figures 2.2 and 2.3 have been updated to show four cofferdams; two on the north shore (northwest and northeast) and two on the south shore (southwest and southeast).
2	Please clarify the footprints of all project components, including those that result in HADD, as the information in Table 2.1/2.2 and Section 7.1 (table below) is difficult to interpret. To assist with this, an Excel file with two tabs has been attached, breaking down the preparatory construction works by location, component, and associated aquatic, riparian, and overwater footprints. Please include similar tables in your updated application.	The provided Excel table has been used as a template to update the FAA application. Table 5.2 shows all PCW footprints by project component and aquatic, riparian and overwater footprints and Table 7.4 shows the PCW HADD footprint for each PCW project component that will result in HADD by habitat type, as well as relative productivity values.
3	Please provide a drawing or design of the cofferdams. If detailed designs are not yet available, a high-level conceptual drawing would be acceptable. Additionally, discuss whether the cofferdam openings could increase the risk of predation or entrapment.	1. Drawings and staging of cofferdams can be found in Attachment 1: drawings FRTP-CFP-NTH-50-MEL-DRG-00008 and FRTP-CFP-CNT-50-MEL-DRG-00011. 2. The cofferdams are designed to be fully open to the river to allow for fish passage at all tide levels for the duration of PCW.
4	Has the scour protection around the cofferdams shown on page 51 of Attachment 1 been accounted for in the aquatic footprint? Section 2.1.4 states: “Additional scour protection footprint required for the cofferdams will be tied into the footprint required for the southeast temporary jetty (Section 2.1.5) and will be discussed there.” Please confirm whether the scour protection for the NE and NW cofferdams has also been included in the footprint calculations.	All scour protection has been accounted for. Where existing scour protection is present, it will be removed and new scour protection will be added. Only scour protection added to natural benthic habitat has been included as a HADD.
5	Please provide detailed information on the works planned for each upland tributary where works could affect fish and fish habitat. The details should include:	Design drawings, which includes culvert diameter and length, are in Attachment 1: sheets 1 and 3 of drawing FRTP-CFP-PWD-50-MEG-DRG-00009. Aquatic and riparian footprints are included in Tables 5.2 and 7.4.
5a	Aquatic and riparian footprints	Tables 5.2 and 7.4
5b	Culvert size and length	Table 2.1
5c	Design drawings or figures	Attachment 1
6	Please provide detailed information regarding the wetland and tidal channel on the south shore of Deas Island in relation to the temporary levelling platform and containment wall:	Information on tidal channel configuration can be found in the following sections: Project Description 2.1.4.1 including reference to design drawing, Existing Conditions 4.3.2.2, and Mitigation 6.2.1
6a	Indicate how frequently the tidal channel is wetted.	Tidal channel inundation frequency is described in Section 4.3.2.2 of the application, and displayed in Figure 4.4.
6b	Include a description and design drawings and/or figures showing the diversion channel and wetland before and during construction.	Design drawing included in Attachment 1, sheet 4 of 4 of drawing FRTP-CFP-PWD-50-MEG-DRG-00009.

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6c	A restoration plan for the tidal channel and wetland must be submitted to DFO for approval following the completion of the preparatory construction works. This plan should include design drawings illustrating the tidal channel and wetland prior to construction, during construction, and after restoration. In addition, a follow-up monitoring program should be implemented to ensure the tidal channel and wetland are restored as closely as possible to pre-disturbance conditions and to confirm that the newly constructed channel does not result in fish stranding or mortality.	Section 9.0 Restoration Plan includes a short description of the proposed PCWA restoration plan including for the tidal channel (Area 3). Design drawings illustrating the tidal channel and wetland prior to construction, during construction, and after restoration, including a follow-up monitoring program will be provided to DFO for approval following completion of the PCW.
7	Please provide a detailed breakdown of the HADD calculation presented in Table 7.4.	A detailed breakdown of PCW HADD footprint by habitat type is provided in Table 7.4